

I. INTRODUCTION TO GRAPH DATA

Traditional Deep Learning models (like CNNs) excel at processing Euclidean data (grids or sequences). However, much of the world's data is **non-Euclidean** and is best represented as a **Graph**.

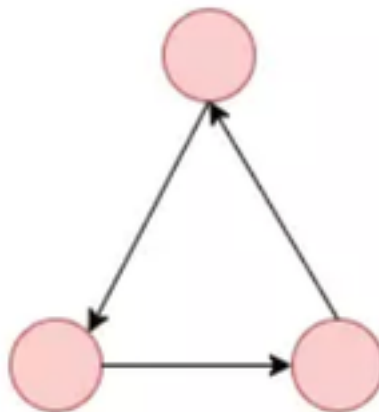
Graphs provide a powerful framework for modeling complex relationships in:

- **Social Networks:** Connections between users.
- **Transportation:** Nodes as cities and edges as roads.
- **Chemical Compounds:** Interactions between molecules.
- **Academic Libraries:** Research papers linked by citations (like your **50-file project**).

1.1. What is a Graph?

A Graph consists of two fundamental components:

- **Nodes (Vertices):** Represent entities (e.g., a person, a place, or an object).
- **Edges (Links):** Define the relationships or dependencies between nodes. Edges can be **Directed** (one-way) or **Undirected** (two-way).



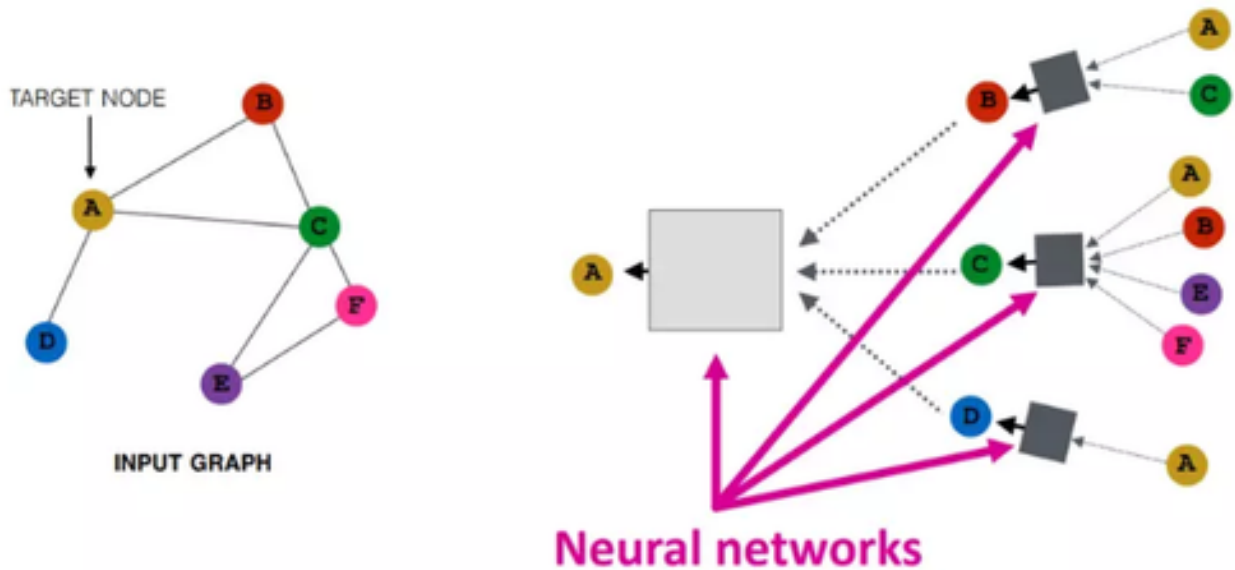
II. CORE CONCEPTS OF GRAPH NEURAL NETWORKS (GNNs)

A GNN is a type of Neural Network specifically designed to operate on the graph structure. It captures information by passing messages through the vertices and edges.

2.1. How GNNs Work

GNNs maintain information about nodes, edges, and global context by converting the input graph into **Graph Embeddings**.

1. **Aggregation:** Each node collects feature vectors from its immediate neighbors.
2. **Combination:** The model updates the node's feature vector by combining its current data with the aggregated neighbor data.
3. **Propagation:** This process repeats across multiple layers, allowing information to flow throughout the graph.



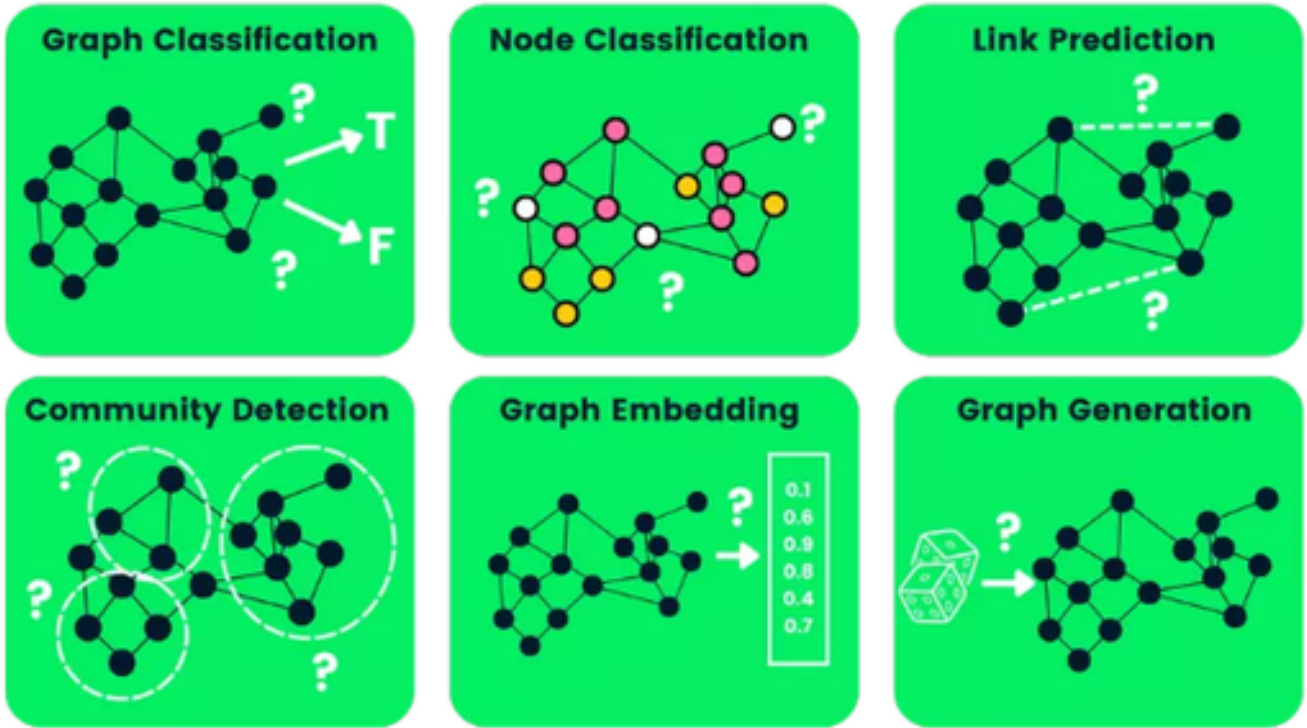
2.2. Common GNN Architectures

- **Graph Convolutional Networks (GCN):** The most popular type; it uses a convolution mechanism to aggregate neighbor information.
- **GraphSAGE:** Uses sampling and aggregation to handle extremely large graphs efficiently.
- **Graph Attention Networks (GAT):** Uses an **Attention Mechanism** to assign different weights (importance) to different neighbors.
- **Graph Autoencoders (GAE):** Used to learn unsupervised embeddings and discover hidden structures.

III. KEY TASKS IN GNNs

GNNs are used to solve various predictive and structural problems:

1. **Node Classification:** Predicting the label of a missing node (e.g., categorizing a document).
2. **Link Prediction:** Predicting whether a relationship exists between two nodes (e.g., "People you may know").
3. **Graph Classification:** Categorizing an entire graph (e.g., identifying if a molecule is toxic).
4. **Community Detection:** Clustering nodes into groups based on edge density.
5. **Graph Embedding:** Mapping graphs into low-dimensional vectors for downstream tasks.



IV. PRACTICAL IMPLEMENTATION (CORA DATASET)

In this example, we use the **Cora Planetoid** dataset—a citation network where nodes are research papers and edges are citations.

4.1. The GCN Architecture

A standard GCN for node classification typically consists of:

- **GCN Layers:** To propagate information.
- **ReLU Activation:** For non-linearity.
- **Dropout:** To prevent overfitting.

4.2. Mathematical Foundation

The update rule for a GCN layer is defined as:

$$x_v^{(\ell+1)} = W^{(\ell+1)} \sum_{w \in N(v) \cup \{v\}} \frac{1}{c_{w,v}} \cdot x_w^{(\ell)}$$

Where:

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$$x_v^{(\ell+1)}$$

- $x_v^{(\ell+1)}$: is the updated feature of node v.
- W : is the weight matrix.
- d_v : is a normalization constant based on the graph structure.

V. VISUALIZATION AND EVALUATION

Before training, nodes are often scattered randomly in the embedding space. After training for 100 epochs (using Adam optimizer and Cross-Entropy loss), the GNN learns to cluster similar nodes together.

- **Performance Metric:** Accuracy is calculated as the percentage of correct label predictions.
- **Visualization:** t-SNE is commonly used to project high-dimensional node embeddings into a 2D plot to observe clearly defined communities.